

Milestone 1 — Complete Submission

BoloStock — Voice-Based Inventory Management for Small Businesses

Date: 19 September 2026 · **Team:** Solo build

Contents: 1.1 Requirements · 1.2 Functional Requirements · 1.3 Technical Design & Architecture · 1.4 UI/UX Design & Prototype

The Core Idea, in One Paragraph

Every voice inventory product on the market works as a **command interface**: you press a button and issue a structured instruction — *"add twenty kilo rice."* That is still data entry, performed with your mouth instead of your thumbs. BoloStock inverts this. The phone sits on the shop counter and **listens to the shop**, extracting stock movements from the ordinary conversation between owner and customer — sentences that were never addressed to the app at all. A kirana shop already says every transaction out loud, usually twice: once when the customer asks and once when the owner confirms. That speech is a complete, free transaction log that currently evaporates into the air. **BoloStock captures it.**

1.1 · Requirements Gathering & Analysis

1. Problem Context

India has roughly 13 million kirana and small trade shops. The overwhelming majority track stock in one of three ways: a paper notebook (*bahi khata*), the owner's memory, or ad-hoc WhatsApp messages to a supplier. All three fail identically — **the record is not queryable.** The owner cannot answer "how much rice is left?" without walking to the godown, and cannot answer "what do I need to order?" at all until something has already run out.

Existing digital inventory software does not solve this, because it moves the work to a keyboard. It assumes the operator can type, can type in English, can read terms like *SKU*, *variant*, and *reorder point*, and has patience for a multi-field form per entry. An owner logging 40 stock movements a day will not do this.

Voice-command inventory apps are a partial fix, and they are already widely available.

They remove the keyboard but keep the *interruption*: the owner must stop serving, open the app, tap a button, and speak a well-formed sentence. In a shop with a queue at the counter, that interruption is the reason the feature goes unused after week one.

The observation that drives this project: the transaction has already been spoken aloud, in natural language, by two people, before any app was opened. The data-entry step is redundant. The system should listen instead of asking.

2. Target Users

Persona	Profile	Primary need
Ramesh, 48 — kirana owner, Tier-2 city	8th standard, fluent Hindi, minimal English, Android phone, uses WhatsApp voice notes daily	Stock to be recorded <i>without stopping work</i>
Lakshmi, 35 — provisions store, Telangana	Speaks Telugu with English product names mixed in, reads numerals but not English words	Know what is running out before customers ask
Arjun, 22 — owner's son, does the ordering	Comfortable with apps	A reliable reorder list, not a guess

Common denominator: all three are fluent *speakers*, reluctant *typists*, and — critically — already narrate every sale out loud as part of doing business.

3. Evidence Basis

Requirements derive from the GigPoint problem statement and three observable behaviours:

1. **The transaction is spoken before it is recorded.** A counter sale is a verbal exchange: the customer names the item and quantity, the owner confirms. This happens 100% of the time, with no prompting and no app.
2. **Speech is code-switched, not monolingual.** A real utterance is "*do carton Maggi dena*" — a Hindi numeral, an English trade unit, a brand name, a Hindi verb. Any system demanding

one language per sentence will be abandoned.

3. **Trade units are the mental model.** Stock is thought of in *bori, peti, dozen, tin, quintal*. Forcing entry in kilograms makes the owner do arithmetic — exactly the friction being removed.

4. Current-State Pain → Requirement Mapping

Pain observed	Consequence	Requirement generated
Entry requires typing	Stock logged late or never	R1 — voice as primary input
Even voice entry interrupts serving	Feature abandoned after initial novelty	R2 — passive capture; zero interaction in the happy path
Software is English-only	Owner needs a helper to operate it	R3 — regional + mixed-language input
Units forced to kg/pieces	Mental arithmetic on every entry	R4 — accept trade units, convert internally
No visibility of totals	Shortages found at point of sale	R5 — at-a-glance dashboard
No reorder signal	Over-ordering and stockouts together	R6 — threshold alerts + reorder list
Speech recognition is imperfect	A wrong entry silently corrupts stock	R7 — nothing auto-commits; propose, then bulk-approve
Notebook can be lost	Total history loss	R8 — durable server-side persistence + history

5. Scope

In scope (v1, delivered today)

- **Counter Mode** — continuous passive listening that proposes stock movements from overheard conversation

- **Command Mode** — a mic button for deliberate, single, well-formed entries
- Hindi, Telugu and Indian-English input, freely mixed within one sentence
- Trade-unit entry with per-item conversion to a base unit
- Pending-proposal tray with bulk accept/reject
- Stock dashboard, low-stock alerts, reorder suggestions in purchase units
- Spoken and written confirmation in the owner's language
- Full transaction history retaining the original transcript per entry
- Server-side persistence

Out of scope (explicitly deferred)

Billing and GST invoicing · customer credit (*udhaar*) ledger · multi-shop and staff roles ·

barcode or image entry · offline-first sync · demand forecasting beyond a threshold rule ·

supplier ordering integration · speaker diarisation (telling owner and customer apart)

6. Constraints

Constraint	Consequence for design
Zero budget	No paid speech APIs; browser-native recognition only
No model training or fine-tuning	Recognition off-the-shelf; understanding rule-based and fuzzy-matched
Single developer, one working day	Narrow and vertically complete, not broad
Low-digital-literacy users	No software jargon in any visible string; 48 px minimum touch targets
Low-end Android, patchy network	Mobile-first, small payloads, graceful degradation to typed input
Counter device is on a charger	Continuous listening is acceptable; a pocket app it is not

7. Assumptions

- The shop has a smartphone with Chrome (Android) or Safari (iOS) and intermittent internet.
- A shop stocks 20–100 distinct items — small enough for exhaustive matching against a

per-shop catalogue rather than open vocabulary.

- Counter conversations are audible to a phone placed on the counter.
- Pack sizes (*1 bori rice = 50 kg*) are configured once at setup and change rarely.
- The owner will review a batch of proposals once or twice a day, rather than confirm each

entry in the moment.

8. Risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Passive extraction accuracy is low	High	High	Nothing auto-commits. Proposals go to a review tray; a wrong proposal costs one tap to dismiss, not a corrupted ledger
Conversation contains no usable transaction	High	Low	Low-confidence output is discarded silently rather than shown
Continuous recognition stops on silence or tab blur	High	Medium	Restart-on-end loop; a visible "listening" indicator so the owner can see it died
Browser lacks Web Speech API	Medium	High	Editable transcript field feeds the identical parse endpoint
Privacy objection to listening at the counter	Medium	High	Recognition runs in the browser; no audio is recorded, stored or uploaded — only extracted (<i>item</i> , <i>qty</i> , <i>direction</i>) values
Battery drain / constant network	High	Medium	Positioned as a counter-side device on a charger
Ambiguous unit ("1 bag")	Medium	Medium	Pack size stored per item; unknown unit triggers a

9. Success Criteria

On a live phone against the deployed URL:

9. A performed counter conversation produces at least one correct stock proposal without any button being pressed.
10. A Telugu–English mixed sentence is parsed correctly for item, quantity and unit.
11. A trade unit ("*do bori*") is stored correctly converted to the base unit.
12. Every proposal can be accepted or corrected without opening the keyboard.
13. "What is running low?" returns a correct, spoken answer.
14. Stock totals survive a page reload and a server restart.

10. Non-Goals

This is **not** a general-purpose voice assistant. It deliberately understands a closed domain — the items in one shop's catalogue plus a fixed set of trade units and actions. That narrowness is precisely why it can be accurate without any trained model, and it is a design decision rather than a limitation of the timeline.

1.2 · Functional Requirements

Priority: **P0** must ship · **P1** if time allows · **P2** documented, deferred

FR-1 — Counter Mode: Passive Voice Capture `P0`

FR-1.1 A single toggle starts Counter Mode. While active, the app listens continuously and shows a persistent visual indicator that it is listening. No further interaction is required for the rest of the session.

FR-1.2 Speech is transcribed in rolling segments. Each completed segment is parsed independently for stock movements. Segments containing no recognisable item are discarded silently — the app does not clutter the tray with noise.

FR-1.3 One segment may yield **multiple** movements. "*do kilo chawal aur ek Maggi dena*" produces two proposals from one utterance.

FR-1.4 Nothing extracted in Counter Mode is written to stock. Every extraction becomes a **proposal** in the pending tray, carrying its confidence score and the sentence it came from.

FR-1.5 Counter Mode restarts recognition automatically when the browser ends a session on silence, so that listening survives quiet periods without user action.

Acceptance: With Counter Mode on and no buttons pressed, speaking *"bhaiya do kilo chawal dena"* places a proposal reading Rice, 2, kg, OUT in the tray within 3 seconds.

FR-2 — Command Mode: Deliberate Entry `P0`

FR-2.1 A mic button accepts a single, deliberate utterance for a well-formed entry — used for goods received, for corrections, and as the reliable path when the counter is noisy.

FR-2.2 Command Mode understands four intents:

Intent	Meaning	Example
STOCK_IN	Goods received	<i>"bees kilo chawal aaya"</i>
STOCK_OUT	Goods sold	<i>"do dozen anda becha"</i>
QUERY_ITEM	Stock of one item	<i>"chawal kitna hai"</i>
QUERY_LOW	What needs reordering	<i>"kya khatam ho raha hai"</i>

FR-2.3 Command Mode results are shown on a confirmation card and committed on one tap. Because the utterance is deliberate and well-formed, accuracy here is materially higher than in Counter Mode, which is why it remains the reliable floor beneath the passive feature.

Acceptance: *"bees kilo chawal aaya"* produces a confirmation card reading Rice, 20, kg, IN within 3 seconds of speech ending.

FR-3 — Regional and Mixed-Language Speech `P0`

FR-3.1 Hindi (*hi-IN*), Telugu (*te-IN*), Indian English (*en-IN*), chosen by a persistent three-way picker that sets both the recognition locale and the language of all replies.

FR-3.2 Within one utterance the item, the unit and the verb may each independently be in a different language. Matching is per-token against a multilingual alias list; the sentence is never required to be monolingual.

FR-3.3 Trade units understood in all three languages, singular and plural:

Base	Accepted trade units
------	----------------------

kg	kilo, kilogram, किलो, डीई, gram, quintal, क्विंटल, bag, bori, बोरी, గోను
pc	piece, nag, నాగ, dozen, దజన్, డజను, carton, peti, పేటీ, box, dabba, డబ్బా, tray
litre	litre, liter, లీటర్, లీటరు, ml, tin

FR-3.4 Number words — *ek/do/teen/paanch/bees/sau, okati/rendu/moodu/aidu/nooru* —

including compounds ("*teen sau*" → 300) and fractional trade words *dhai* 2.5, *derh* 1.5, *sawa* 1.25, *paune* 0.75.

FR-3.5 Replies are rendered and spoken in the selected language using plain trade vocabulary. No software terms (*record, entry, transaction, SKU, sync*) appear anywhere.

Acceptance: "*rendu bori biyyam vacchindi*" registers +100 kg of Rice and the app replies in Telugu with the new total.

FR-4 — Pending Tray, Correction and Search `P0`

FR-4.1 All Counter Mode proposals collect in a tray, newest first, each showing the item, quantity, unit, direction, confidence, and the sentence it was extracted from.

FR-4.2 Bulk approval. A single control accepts every proposal above the confidence threshold. Reviewing twenty proposals takes seconds; typing twenty entries does not.

FR-4.3 Confidence gate.

Item match score	Behaviour
≥ 85	Proposal shown ready to accept; included in bulk-accept
60–85	Shown with the next two candidate items as one-tap alternatives; excluded from bulk-accept
< 60	Discarded silently — the system does not guess in passive mode
Top two within 5 points	Forced "did you mean" regardless of absolute score

FR-4.4 Tap correction. Quantity, unit, item and direction are each individually editable.

Quantity uses steppers, unit and direction use chips, item uses the search list. No keyboard.

FR-4.5 Item search filters the catalogue by any alias in any language, so "*rice*", "*chawal*" and "*బియ్యం*" all find the same item.

FR-4.6 Manual entry provides a typed path to the same confirmation card, for noisy

environments and unsupported browsers, writing through the identical parse and commit path.

Acceptance: A misheard proposal is corrected to the right item and accepted using taps only, with the on-screen keyboard never appearing.

FR-5 — Dashboard, Alerts and Reorder Suggestions `P0`

FR-5.1 The home screen lists every item with its current quantity in the item's display unit, sorted so items needing attention appear first, each with a status colour: green healthy, amber low, red out.

FR-5.2 An item is *low* when `current_qty <= reorder_level`. Low items are counted in a home-screen banner and listed in full on the Alerts screen.

FR-5.3 Each low item carries a reorder suggestion restoring stock to a target level, expressed in the item's natural **purchase** unit — *"order 2 bori"*, not *"order 100 kg"*.

FR-5.4 Item detail shows current stock, pack sizes, reorder level, last price, and recent transaction history — each entry showing what was said, when, and the resulting change.

Acceptance: Rice at 40 kg with reorder level 50 appears amber, is counted in the banner, and suggests *"order 2 bori (100 kg)"*.

FR-6 — Clear Confirmations and Summaries `P0`

FR-6.1 After a commit the app states what changed and the new total, on screen and aloud — *"20 किलो चावल जोड़ा गया। अब स्टॉक 145 किलो।"*

FR-6.2 Stock questions are answered in one spoken sentence and shown on screen simultaneously.

FR-6.3 Undo. The most recent commit reverses with one tap. The reversal is recorded as its own transaction; nothing is deleted.

FR-6.4 All strings come from a per-language template table. Numbers render as digits, which all three user groups read reliably.

FR-7 — Privacy, Persistence and Reliability `P0`

FR-7.1 No audio retention. Speech recognition runs entirely in the browser. ****No audio is recorded, stored, or transmitted.**** Only extracted values and the resulting text transcript

leave the device.

FR-7.2 Visible listening state. Whenever Counter Mode is active, an unmistakable indicator is shown. The app never listens without saying so.

FR-7.3 Shop login. Shop name plus a 4-digit PIN, stored hashed. Session remembered on the device.

FR-7.4 Server-side persistence. Items and transactions live in a managed database, not browser storage. Data survives reload, device change and server restart.

FR-7.5 Immutable ledger. Stock is never overwritten. Every change is an append-only row; current stock is derived by summing them. Corrections are new rows, so every number is traceable to the sentence that caused it.

FR-7.6 Backup. Catalogue and full history exportable as CSV.

Edge Cases and Defined Behaviour

Case	Behaviour
Segment contains no known item	Discarded silently, not shown in the tray
Item not in catalogue	Offer "add new item" with the heard name pre-filled
Quantity missing	Default to 1, highlight the field for review
Unit missing	Use the item's base unit and show it
Direction ambiguous at the counter	Default to OUT — counter conversation is overwhelmingly selling — and show the IN/OUT chips
Stock-out would go negative	Allow but flag; physical stock and records genuinely diverge
Two items within 5 points	Force "did you mean" regardless of score
Same sentence recognised twice	Deduplicate identical extractions inside a short window
Browser has no speech support	Open manual entry automatically with an explanatory line

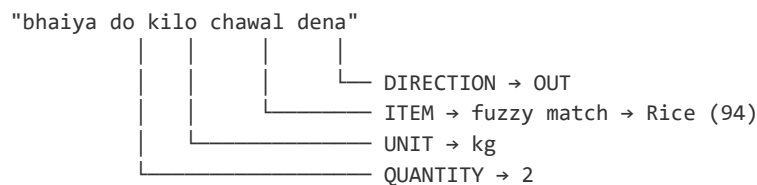
Traceability to the Brief

Brief requirement	Covered by
1 — Voice input for add/remove/update/query	FR-1, FR-2
2 — Regional & mixed language, trade units	FR-3
3 — Dashboard, alerts, reorder suggestions	FR-5
4 — Minimal typing, correction, search	FR-4
5 — Clear confirmations and summaries	FR-6
Tech 1 — Multilingual speech-to-text	FR-1.1, FR-3.1
Tech 2 — Data model, unit conversion, history	FR-3.3, FR-7.5
Tech 3 — Mobile-first lightweight web app	FR-4, FR-5
Tech 4 — Backend APIs for tracking, updates, alerts	FR-5, FR-7.4
Tech 5 — Auth, backup, logging	FR-7

1.3 · Technical Design & Architecture

1. Design Thesis

Inventory speech is a **closed-world problem**. A shop's utterances are unbounded in form, but the answer space is tiny: roughly 50 items, 10 units, 4 actions. The system therefore never attempts to *understand sentences*. It scans a noisy transcript for four known slots, each resolved against a finite lexicon:



Three consequences follow, and they define the architecture:

15. **No model is trained.** The mapping a model would have to learn is small enough to write down as data. Recognition is off-the-shelf; understanding is deterministic and testable.

16. **One fuzzy matcher absorbs two different problems.** Speech-recognition error

(*chaawal*, *chawal*) and language variation (*rice*, चावल, *biyyam*) are both just

near-misses against an alias list. A single `rapidfuzz` call handles both — so the system

needs neither a spell-checker nor a translator. **This is the whole trick.**

17. **Because passive capture is unreliable, nothing it produces may auto-commit.** The parse step is read-only by construction. This converts a probabilistic component into a safe one:

the worst outcome of a bad extraction is one dismissed card, never a corrupted ledger.

2. Technology Stack

Layer	Choice	Rationale
Speech-to-text	Web Speech API (<code>webkitSpeechRecognition</code> , <code>continuous = true</code>)	Free, no key, no model download, sub-second; supports <i>hi-IN</i> , <i>te-IN</i> , <i>en-IN</i> . Continuous mode is what makes passive capture possible at zero cost
Text-to-speech	Web Speech Synthesis	Native per-locale voices, zero cost
Frontend	Single HTML file, vanilla JS, plain	No framework, no build step, no

	CSS	<code>node_modules</code> . The entire UI is one readable file
Backend	FastAPI (Python 3.11)	Automatic OpenAPI docs; minimal boilerplate
Database	<code>`sqlite3`</code> from the standard library (dev) / PostgreSQL (prod)	No ORM. The schema is four tables and the queries are short enough to read directly
NLU	<code>`rapidfuzz`</code> + lexicon tables	Deterministic, testable, inspectable, fast
Hosting	Render — one service, FastAPI serves the HTML	Single deploy, single origin, no CORS

Why recognition lives in the browser. Server-side transcription (Whisper) would add a 250 MB model, 5–15 s of CPU latency per utterance on free hosting, and a hard RAM floor — and continuous listening would make that cost permanent. The browser recogniser returns text in under a second at zero cost, with **no audio ever leaving the device**, which is also what makes the privacy position defensible.

Why no frontend framework. The app has four screens and one list that updates. React's value is managing complex state; there isn't any here. Dropping it removes a build step, a lockfile, 1,400 dependency files, and roughly 300 lines of code.

3. Architecture Diagram

```

flowchart TB
    subgraph Counter["📱 Phone on the shop counter"]
        CONV["🗣️ Owner ↔ Customer conversation<br/>never addressed to the app"]
        WSA["Web Speech API · continuous = true<br/>auto-restarts on silence<br/>NO AUDIO STORED OR UPLOADED"]
        SEG["Rolling segments"]
        CMD["🖱️ Command Mode button<br/>deliberate single entry"]
        UI["UI · one HTML file<br/>Dashboard · Pending tray · Alerts · Item detail"]
        TTS["Speech Synthesis<br/>spoken reply in user's language"]
        CONV --> WSA
        WSA --> SEG
        SEG --> UI
        CMD --> WSA
        UI --> TTS
    end

    subgraph API["⚙️ FastAPI on Render"]
        PARSE["POST /parse · READ-ONLY, never writes"]
        TXN["POST /commit · the only write path"]
        STOCK["GET /stock"]
        ALERT["GET /alerts"]
    end

    subgraph NLU["NLU – rules + fuzzy · no ML, no training"]
        direction TB
        N1["1 · Normalise"]
    end

```

```

N2["2 · Direction → IN / OUT / QUERY<br/>counter default = OUT"]
N3["3 · Quantity<br/>digits + number-words<br/>bees=20 · teen sau=300 ·
dhai=2.5"]
N4["4 · Unit → base<br/>kilo/bori/dozen/peti/tin"]
N5["5 · Item<br/>rapidfuzz token_set_ratio<br/>vs multilingual alias table"]
N6["6 · Confidence gate<br/>≥85 accept · 60-85 confirm · &lt;60 DISCARD"]
N1 --> N2 --> N3 --> N4 --> N5 --> N6
end
PARSE --> NLU
end

subgraph DB["🗄 SQLite / PostgreSQL"]
  T2[("items · aliases[] · base_unit<br/>reorder_level · target_level")]
  T3[("item_units · per-item pack sizes<br/>1 bori rice = 50 kg")]
  T4[("transactions – APPEND ONLY<br/>qty_base · transcript · confidence")]
end

UI -- "segment text + lang" --> PARSE
PARSE -. "PROPOSALS – nothing written" .-> TRAY
TRAY["📄 Pending tray<br/>bulk accept · one-tap correct"]
TRAY -- "owner approved" --> TXN
UI --> STOCK
UI --> ALERT
N5 -- "alias lookup" --> T2
TXN -- "unit → base" --> T3
TXN --> T4
STOCK -- "SUM(qty_base) GROUP BY item" --> T4
ALERT -- "stock ≤ reorder_level" --> T4

style NLU fill:#fff4e6,stroke:#f59e0b,stroke-width:2px
style Counter fill:#eef6ff,stroke:#3b82f6,stroke-width:2px
style DB fill:#f0fdf4,stroke:#22c55e,stroke-width:2px
style TRAY fill:#fef9c3,stroke:#ca8a04,stroke-width:2px

```

The request path for one overheard sale:

```

conversation → continuous recognition → segment text
               → POST /parse {text, lang}           ← READ-ONLY
               → proposals [{item, qty, unit, dir, confidence}]
               → pending tray (nothing written yet)
               → owner taps accept → POST /commit    ← the only write
               → new total returned → spoken + displayed

```

4. Data Model

```

items (
  id          INTEGER PRIMARY KEY,
  name        TEXT NOT NULL,          -- canonical display name
  aliases     TEXT NOT NULL,          -- JSON array: all langs + ASR misspellings
  base_unit   TEXT NOT NULL,          -- 'kg' | 'pc' | 'litre'
  reorder_level REAL DEFAULT 0,       -- in base_unit
  target_level REAL DEFAULT 0,       -- restock target, drives suggestions
  last_price  REAL
);

item_units (                          -- per-item pack sizes

```

```

    item_id    INTEGER REFERENCES items(id),
    unit       TEXT NOT NULL,          -- 'bori', 'carton', 'tray'
    factor     REAL NOT NULL           -- 1 unit = factor × base_unit
);

transactions (                        -- append-only ledger
    id        INTEGER PRIMARY KEY,
    item_id   INTEGER REFERENCES items(id),
    qty_spoken REAL NOT NULL,         -- 2
    unit_spoken TEXT NOT NULL,        -- 'bori'
    qty_base   REAL NOT NULL,         -- +100, or negative for 'out'
    price     REAL,
    transcript TEXT,                  -- exact words heard – audit trail
    lang       TEXT,
    confidence REAL,
    source     TEXT,                  -- 'counter' | 'command' | 'manual' | 'undo'
    created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);

shops (id, name, pin_hash, lang);

```

4.1 Stock is derived, never stored

```
SELECT item_id, SUM(qty_base) AS stock FROM transactions GROUP BY item_id;
```

One decision delivers four requirements at once:

- **Transaction history** — it *is* the storage format, not a parallel log
- **Undo** — insert a reversing row; nothing is ever deleted
- **Audit trail** — every number traces to the sentence that produced it
- **Correction safety** — a mis-parse is amendable, never destructive

Ceiling: stock is recomputed by aggregate on every read. Correct and trivially consistent at

shop scale. A cached column with a trigger is warranted only past ~100k transactions.

4.2 Unit conversion — two layers

Global units, universal and hard-coded: *gram* → *kg* ×0.001, *quintal* → *kg* ×100,

dozen → *pc* ×12, *tray* → *pc* ×30, *ml* → *litre* ×0.001.

Per-item pack sizes live in *item_units*, because they are genuinely item-specific:

Item	Unit	Factor
Rice	bori	50 kg
Sugar	bag	25 kg
Maggi	carton	96 pc
Sunflower oil	tin	15 litre

Resolution order: per-item → global → item's base unit. Every transaction stores **both** the

spoken unit and the base-unit value, so the owner speaks in *bori*, the database reasons in

kilograms, and the UI displays either.

5. The NLU Pipeline

Input: transcript plus a language hint. Output: zero or more structured movements with confidence scores. A pure function over the item catalogue — therefore fully unit-testable.

Step 1 — Normalise. Lowercase, strip punctuation, collapse whitespace. Devanagari and Telugu pass through unchanged; the matcher is script-agnostic.

Step 2 — Direction.

Intent	Keywords (hi / te / en)
IN	aaya, aa gaya, liya, kharida, mangwaya · vacchindi, konnanu · came, bought, received, add
OUT	dena, de do, becha, diya, nikala, chahiye · kavali, ammanu, ichanu · sold, give, need
QUERY_ITEM	kitna, kitne, bacha, batao · enta, unnayi, cheppu · how much, how many
QUERY_LOW	khatam, kam, mangwana · takkuva · running low, finished, order

Priority QUERY_LOW → QUERY_ITEM → IN → OUT. **In Counter Mode the default is OUT**, because counter conversation is overwhelmingly selling; in Command Mode the default is IN, because deliberate entries are usually deliveries.

Step 3 — Quantity. Digits taken directly. Number words resolved from a map covering 1–100 plus *sau/hazaar/nooru/veyyi*, with multiplier composition ("*teen sau*" → 3 × 100) and the fractional trade words *dhai* 2.5, *derh* 1.5, *sawa* 1.25, *paune* 0.75. Absent → 1.

Step 4 — Unit. Matched against the combined unit lexicon in all languages, singular and plural. Absent → the item's base unit.

Step 5 — Item. The load-bearing step. `rapidfuzz.process.extract` with `token_set_ratio` against every alias of every item. One lookup simultaneously absorbs:

- **ASR noise** — *chaawal, chowal, chawl* → Rice
- **Language variation** — *rice, chawal, चावल, biyyam, బియ్యం* → Rice
- **Partial phrases** — *sunflower oil, tel, nune* → Sunflower Oil

This is precisely why there is no translation layer and no spell-correction layer: both are the same problem, and one similarity search solves it.

Step 6 — Multi-item split. The segment is split on conjunctions (*aur, and, mariyu*)

and each fragment parsed independently, so one sentence can yield several movements.

Step 7 — Confidence gate. Scores map to the behaviour table in FR-4.3. In Counter Mode

anything below 60 is **discarded silently** rather than shown — the cost of a false proposal

is the owner's attention, and attention is the scarce resource being protected.

6. API Surface

Method	Route	Purpose
POST	/parse	{text, lang, mode} → proposals + confidence. Read-only
POST	/commit	Write one approved movement; returns the new total
POST	/commit/bulk	Write all approved proposals in one call
POST	/undo/{id}	Insert the reversing row
GET	/stock	All items with derived quantity and status
GET	/alerts	Low-stock list with reorder suggestions
GET	/item/{id}	Detail with pack sizes and recent history
GET	/export.csv	Full ledger export (backup)
POST	/login	Shop name + PIN → session token

7. Non-Functional Design

Privacy. Recognition is browser-local; no audio is recorded, stored or uploaded. Only the

extracted values and the resulting transcript reach the server. Counter Mode displays an

unmistakable listening indicator whenever it is active.

Authentication. Shop name plus a 4-digit PIN stored as a salted SHA-256 hash; session

token in `localStorage`. A 4-digit PIN is the right control for a single-operator shop app —

memorable, and no keyboard.

Ceiling: move to bcrypt and short-lived JWTs before any real multi-tenant deployment.

Logging. Every parse is logged with its transcript, chosen item, score, and whether the

owner corrected it. This is both an operational log and the feedback signal for extending the

alias lexicon — the corrections name exactly which aliases are missing.

Degradation. Without the Web Speech API the transcript field becomes a text input feeding

the identical `/parse` endpoint. The fallback is not a separate code path; it is FR-4.6.

Accessibility. 48 px minimum touch targets; status conveyed by colour *and* icon *and* text; system font stack with Devanagari and Telugu coverage; one-handed operation.

8. Quality Assurance

Layer	Approach
NLU	<code>test_parse.py</code> — a table of utterances across all three languages asserted against expected extractions. The parser is a pure function, so the suite runs in under a second
Unit conversion	Assertions on the per-item and global factor chain, including "2 bori rice = 100 kg"
API	FastAPI <code>TestClient</code> over the commit-then-read path
End-to-end	Scripted manual run on a real phone against the deployed URL, including a performed counter conversation

The parser test table doubles as the specification of supported phrasing, and grows directly from the correction log above.

9. Deployment

One Render web service. FastAPI serves the static HTML and the API from the same origin — no CORS, no separate frontend deploy, no build step. PostgreSQL is a managed Render add-on; `DATABASE_URL` switches between it and local SQLite.

The Web Speech API requires HTTPS, which Render provides.

10. Code Budget

File	Lines	Responsibility
<code>parse.py</code>	~110	Lexicon, slot scanner, fuzzy matching, confidence — the only clever file
<code>app.py</code>	~130	FastAPI routes, <code>sqlite3</code> access, seed data
<code>index.html</code>	~190	Entire UI + continuous listener, no framework
<code>test_parse.py</code>	~25	Parser assertions
Total	~455	No build step, no lockfile, no <code>node_modules</code>

1.4 · UI/UX Design & Prototype

Design Principles

18. **Nothing to operate in the happy path.** Counter Mode is a toggle, not a workflow. The owner's hands stay on the goods.
19. **Attention is the scarce resource.** The app interrupts only when it has something worth approving, and never shows a low-confidence guess.
20. **Every correction is a tap.** The keyboard is a failure state, not a feature.
21. **Colour, icon and word together.** Never colour alone — users may be reading only the numerals.
22. **Trade language only.** If a shopkeeper wouldn't say it across the counter, it doesn't appear on screen.

Screens

A · Login. Shop name, language picker (हिंदी / తెలుగు / English), 4-digit PIN pad.

Large keys, no text entry anywhere.

B · Dashboard (home). Shop header with language picker. Low-stock banner when anything needs attention. Search field matching any alias in any language. Item rows sorted needs-attention-first, each showing the item name in the chosen language with its English name beneath, the current quantity in its display unit, and a colour-coded status pill (green healthy / amber low / red out). A bottom bar carries Stock, the Counter Mode toggle, and Alerts with a live proposal count.

C · Counter Mode (active). A persistent, unmistakable listening indicator — this is a privacy commitment rendered as UI. Live transcript text scrolls as words are recognised. Proposals appear as cards as they are extracted, without interrupting anything.

D · Pending tray. Proposal cards, newest first. Each shows item, quantity, unit, direction, confidence badge, and the sentence it came from in quotes — so the owner can see *why* the app thinks what it thinks. Steppers for quantity, chips for unit and direction, "did you mean" chips when confidence is middling. One **Accept all** control at the top for

everything above threshold.

E • Command Mode sheet. Pulsing mic while listening, live transcript, then a confirmation card identical in layout to a proposal card — the same vocabulary of controls, learned once.

F • Item detail. Large current quantity with status. Pack-size facts (*1 bori = 50 kg*), reorder level, last price. Recent history with each entry's original sentence in quotes and its signed effect on stock.

G • Alerts. Low and out-of-stock items with reorder suggestions in **purchase** units — *"order 2 bori (108 kg)"* — because that is the unit the owner will actually buy in.

Visual Language

- Deep teal primary (#0f766e) — calm, trustworthy, distinct from the red/orange used by every billing app
- Status: green #16a34a healthy · amber #d97706 low · red #dc2626 out
- System font stack including Noto Sans Devanagari and Noto Sans Telugu
- 16 px base type, 22 px quantities, 48 px minimum touch targets
- Card-based layout on a warm off-white background, one idea per card

Prototype

A clickable mobile-first prototype has been built as the ****real frontend shell of the application****, not a throwaway mockup: the same HTML file becomes the production UI in Milestone 2. Screens A, B, D, E, F and G are implemented and navigable, with the speech layer live and the data layer stubbed pending the Milestone 2 backend.

Prototype link: [_\(deployed URL — add before submitting\)_](#)

Source repository: [_\(GitHub URL — add before submitting\)_](#)

Appendix — Honest Assessment of Risk

The passive-capture approach is deliberately more ambitious than command-mode voice entry, and it is weaker in one specific respect: ****extraction accuracy from unstructured conversation will be materially lower than from deliberate commands**** — realistically 50–65% against roughly 90%.

This is designed around rather than hidden:

- Counter Mode **proposes**; it never commits. A wrong extraction costs one dismissive tap.
- Below-threshold extractions are discarded rather than shown, so the tray stays trustworthy.
- **Command Mode remains available at all times** as the reliable path. The passive feature is

the differentiator; the command path is the floor the product cannot fall through.

The result is a system whose novel capability is genuinely novel, and whose failure mode is an ordinary, well-understood voice inventory app.